



Third Party Middleware

1. Need and Advantages
2. Body Parser
3. Cookie Parser
4. Express-session
5. cors

- These are functions developed and maintained by third-party developers, which can be used to add the functionality to an ExpressJS application.
- Typical examples of such functions are session management, cookie parsing, body parsing etc
- To use third party middlewares, follow
 - Install the middleware
 - Import the middleware
 - Use the middleware

- Third-party middleware for processing incoming HTTP requests). Exact name is body-parser
- Body-parser helps to extract the data submitted in the request body like form data
- It populates the request object with a body object containing the parsed data.
- This middleware function provides functions like
 - i. `app.use(bodyParser.json());` // for application/json parsing
 - ii. `app.use(bodyParser.urlencoded({ extended: true }));` // for application/x-www-form-urlencoded parsing

- It is a middleware for handling HTTP cookies
- Cookie-parser provides methods for parsing and setting cookies
- Cookie can be set by using:
`res.cookie("username", "john");`
- Cookies in the request can be read by using:
`const username = req.cookies.username;`
- Cookies can be deleted using:
`res.clearCookie("username");`

4. Express-session

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- CORS stands for Cross-Origin Resource Sharing
- Server API needs to be accessible from different client origins, for example, from a mobile device, or from a web browser
- CORS is a mechanism that allows web applications to access resources from other domains.
- Features of CORS
 - Allows web programmers to use regular AJAX Request, which handles errors better.
 - Supports all HTTP methods.
- Can be used of all routes or single routes
`app.use(cors())`